

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1301

By Haston

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Gayle Duncan Gilmer of Franklin.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Gayle Duncan Gilmer of Franklin; and

WHEREAS, Gayle Duncan Gilmer was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on July 6, 1943, in Lobelville, Ms. Gilmer was the daughter of Homer and Mabel Long Duncan; and

WHEREAS, in 1961, Gayle Gilmer graduated as valedictorian from Lobelville High School; as a lifelong learner, she emphasized the importance of education to her family and others who were fortunate to know her; and

WHEREAS, on April 3, 1964, Ms. Gilmer married Jacky Wayne Gilmer, with whom she spent fifty-two years, most of which were spent living on the family farm in Gilmer Hollow, near Lobelville; and

WHEREAS, after her children were grown, Gayle Gilmer returned to her studies and earned a bachelor's and a master's degree from the University of Tennessee at Martin; she furthered her graduate education at Vanderbilt University; and

WHEREAS, greatly admired by her community and colleagues, Ms. Gilmer enjoyed a meaningful career in education as a special education teacher at Perry County High School; and

WHEREAS, a devoted Christian, Gayle Gilmer was baptized at Lobelville Church of Christ, where she was an active member for many years; she later became an active member in the Crooked Creek congregation and at Brentwood Hills Church of Christ; and

WHEREAS, in addition to serving the school system and church congregations, Ms. Gilmer was a community volunteer who served on hospital and library boards; and

WHEREAS, Gayle Gilmer was deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Gilmer is survived by her son, Scott (Amber) Gilmer; daughter, Shelby (Michael) Elswick, M.D.; grandchildren, Adaline Gilmer, Hope (Connor) Manuel, Hunter (Emily) Olds, Sydney Olds, Skylar Olds, Lawson Olds, Brady Elswick, Brooks Elswick, Noah Elswick, and Amber (Travis) Dales; great-grandchildren, Sage Manuel and Bentley Dales; and several other family members and friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her parents, she was preceded in death by her husband; her brother, Van Duncan; and her grandparents, William T. and Mary Lora Brown Duncan and Henry Hugh and Hattie Coble Long, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, Gayle Gilmer leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Gayle Duncan Gilmer, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Ms. Gilmer.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.